



➤ **MUKESH BAFNA**, Managing Director, The MWB Group (Hubli)

MWB GROUP - RISING STAR OF SOUTH INDIA IN FOOD & STAPLES INDUSTRY

The 40 Year Old Mukesh Bafna joined the family business after completing his Masters in Business & Finance from Jain University, Bangalore. Bringing with him new ideas and strategies, he has transformed his grandfather Shri Mutha Wagmal Bhuraji Bafna's business into a powerhouse. The MWB Group today commands a strong presence in the Retail Shelf Spaces with a portfolio of 200 plus SKUs that cater to every segment of society. With interests in wholesale, retail, logistics, energy and technology, the group has diversified well into future ready conglomerate.

What started off as a Retail Store with 3 employees in 1971 is today a Business House with a Rs. 1500Cr+ turnover and 700 + workforce. South India's largest Pulses Merchants, group is firmly entrenched in the kitchens of Karnataka, Kerala, Tamil Nadu and Goa with a strong portfolio of products. More than 1 Lakh People consume MWB Group Products sold from an extensive network of retailers. Available in the Wholesale and Retail format, the MWB touches the lives of people in these states in one form or the other.

The MWB Group has steadily risen up owing to the relentless efforts of three generations of Bafnas. Today it has emerged as South India's leading wholesalers for Rice, Wheat, Pulses, Cereals, Flours, Oil, Jaggery, Basmati, Masala, Dry fruits and other Grocery Products. With a family of 40,000 + retailers promoting and distributing their quality products, the group has established a superb network that caters to the entire South India and Goa. MWB Pack Products reaches to more than 10,000 Households Daily and more than 1 Lakh People Consume MWB Group Products. This has been possible because of micro level marketing of reaching out to retailers directly in Karnataka and Goa.

MWB Group has been the Market Leaders for more than 50 Years because of their vision to change with changing time. Scientific planning and holistic approach have been the pillars of growth of the Group. As the Managing Director Mukesh Bafna says, "Meeting the needs of the market, adapting to changing times and investing in the right opportunities while staying committed to serve the society has been the hallmark of our success".

It was a step by step progression for the Bafnas. The level of the strategic planning and the perfection of execution is visible in their growth. They transformed the store into a flourishing wholesale and retail business of Pulses & Foodgrains. They built on their connection with farmers, to start trading in 1978. They powered wholesaling as a business, reaching out to nearly 40,000 retailers across Karnataka and Goa with branches in Hubballi, Shivamogga, Mysuru, Dharwad, Belagavi, Kundapur. Guided by the founder's golden rule –

"ensure the right weight and rate" to farmers, the Bafnas leveraged on Late Mutha Wagmal Bhuraji's rapport with the ryots and strengthened it. The group works directly or indirectly with more than 1 Lakh farmers, trying to give them the best price for their crops.

The Bafnas then ventured into the next level of their systematic yet strategic forward integration initiative. They have built South India's biggest Dal Mill with a capacity of 300 tonnes per day. With this in place, they put out more than 70 branded SKUs in the market shelves, comprising 20 different Pulses and Cereals. Taking a step further into retailing, they launched their signature WB Retail outlet in 2018 in Akkihonda of Hubballi. A state-of-the-art infrastructure with fully computerised facility, it offers all kitchen needs under the theme 'All Your Kitchen Needs Simplified'.

Mukesh Bafna is betting on technology to be the future driver of the group. The group ventured into software development with the formation of MWB Technologies India Pvt. Ltd. in 2019. It develops solutions for inhouse use that have since then been rolled out to the business community as a whole. Extending further, a hardware division too has taken shape.

As a CSR initiative, MWB Tech launched the Kalpavriksha Business App for North Karnataka, As on date it has got 8000 businesses and professionals registered in it. There are plans to go national with it, soon.

The MWB Group strongly believes that customers are the key to the success of any organisation. As Mukesh puts it, "Customers are too good to lose." They are doing their bit to engage them at all levels.

With such an approach, we say they are a Customer Delight.

YOU CAN REACH THEM AT WWW.MWBGROUPS.COM OR
MUKESHBAFNA@MWBGROUPS.COM